

ServiceNow User Interface

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2	Creation of SNow Instance
3	What is User Interface (UI)?

1. ServiceNow Instance

Definition

A **ServiceNow Instance** is a dedicated and fully independent working environment hosted on the ServiceNow cloud platform. It contains its own applications, database, configurations, users, and security. Each organization gets separate instances to perform development, testing, and production activities without affecting each other. Instances are accessed via a web URL such as `https://companyname.service-now.com`.

Purpose / Why it is used

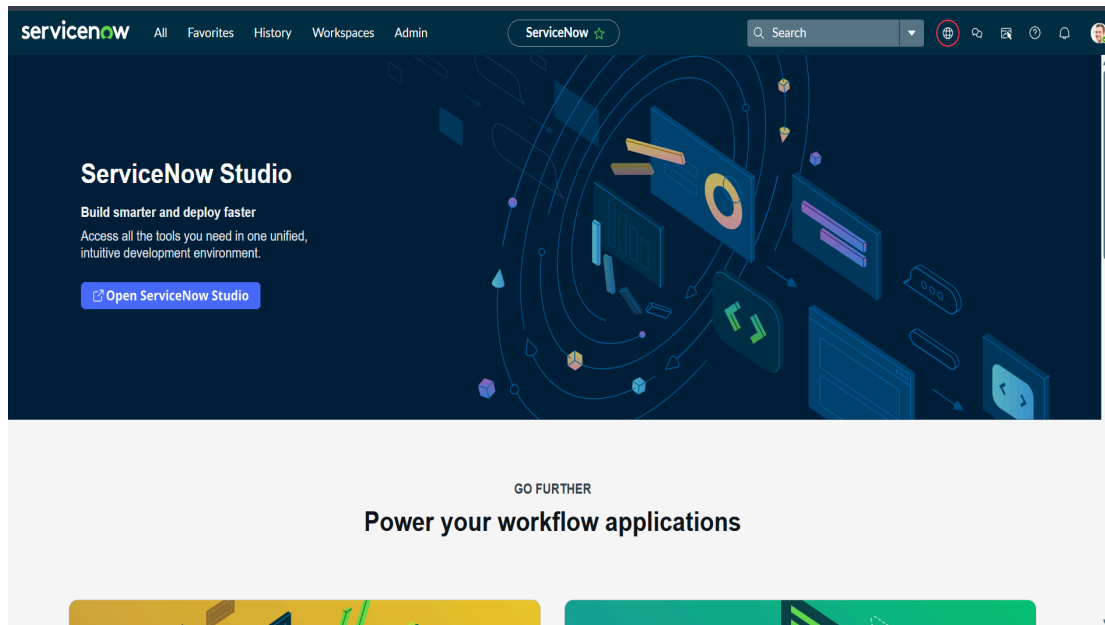
- To provide a secure workspace for building and using applications.
- To separate development, testing, and live business operations.
- To ensure no risk to production while customization is ongoing.

Example Scenario

A developer builds a new workflow in **DEV** → QA team verifies it in **TEST** → finally deployed to **PROD** where employees work on it.

Screenshot Description (Classic UI)

The instance homepage shows:



Types of ServiceNow Instances

ServiceNow uses **multiple instances** to ensure configuration/development does not break business-critical live operations.

The three most commonly used instances are:

1. **Development Instance (DEV)**
2. **Test / QA Instance (TEST / UAT / PRE-PROD)**
3. **Production Instance (PROD)**

1. Development Instance (DEV)

What it is

Development instance is the **workspace where system administrators, developers, and consultants build and customize applications.**

All new configurations and changes are first created here.

Purpose / Why it is used

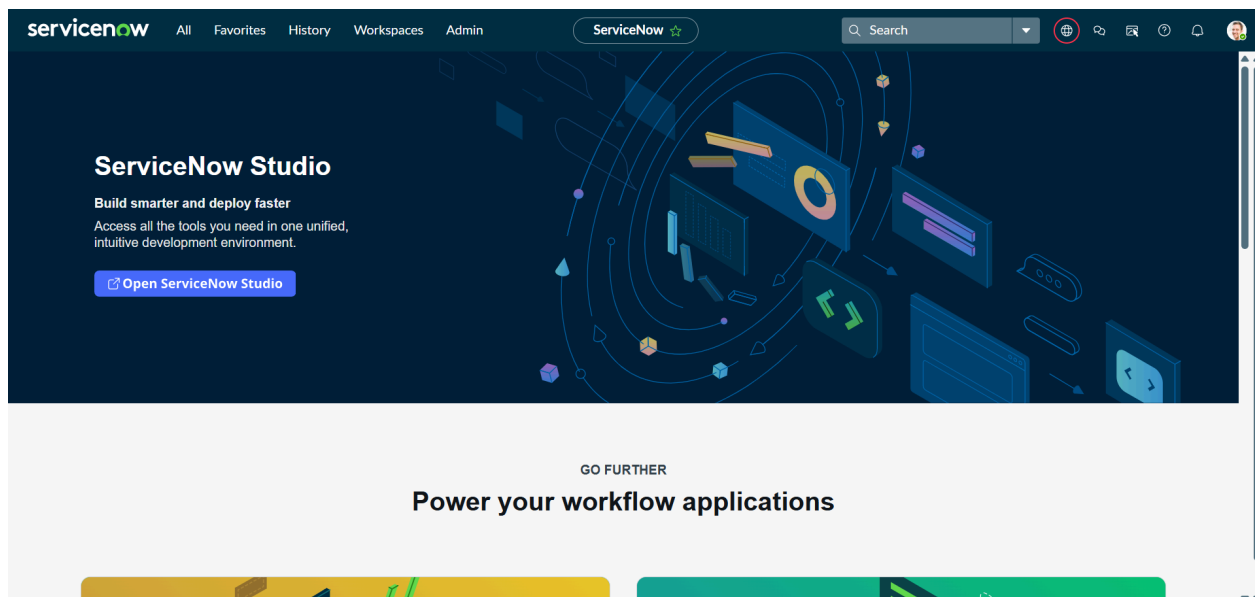
- To develop workflows, business rules, UI policies, forms, tables, integrations, ACLs etc.
- To experiment and test new ideas without risk.
- To collaborate on ongoing development safely.

Example Scenarios

Scenario	What happens
New change form needed	Developer creates new form in DEV
SLA not calculating correctly	Admin modifies SLA conditions in DEV
API integration required	Developer builds REST integration in DEV

Important

If anything breaks in DEV → only developers are affected, not business users.



2. Test / QA Instance (TEST / UAT / PRE-PROD)

What it is

A replica of the Development instance used for **testing and validation before changes go live**.

This instance receives updates through **update sets or deployments** from the DEV instance.

Alternative names depending on organization:

Name	Meaning
TEST	Testing
QA	Quality Assurance
UAT	User Acceptance Testing
PRE-PROD	Pre-Production

Purpose / Why it is used

- To validate and test the developed features.
- To allow users and QA team to approve changes.
- To ensure nothing breaks before going live in PROD.

Example Scenarios

Scenario	Result
Developer created new approval workflow	QA tests all workflow steps in TEST
New role added	UAT checks whether permissions behave correctly
New integration	QA validates that data flows without error

Important

Changes only move to PROD **after passing all tests in TEST**.

3. Production Instance (PROD)

What it is

The **live instance used by the real business users** to perform daily work.

This instance contains all **actual business data**, including Incidents, Problems, Changes, Requests, Catalog, CMDB records, KPIs, etc.

Purpose / Why it is used

- To run real-time business operations.
- To maintain continuous service availability.
- To store official and secure organization data.

Example Scenarios

Scenario	What happens
Employee raises an incident	Stored and processed in PROD
Service desk updates ticket status	Done in PROD
CAB approves a change request	In PROD workflow

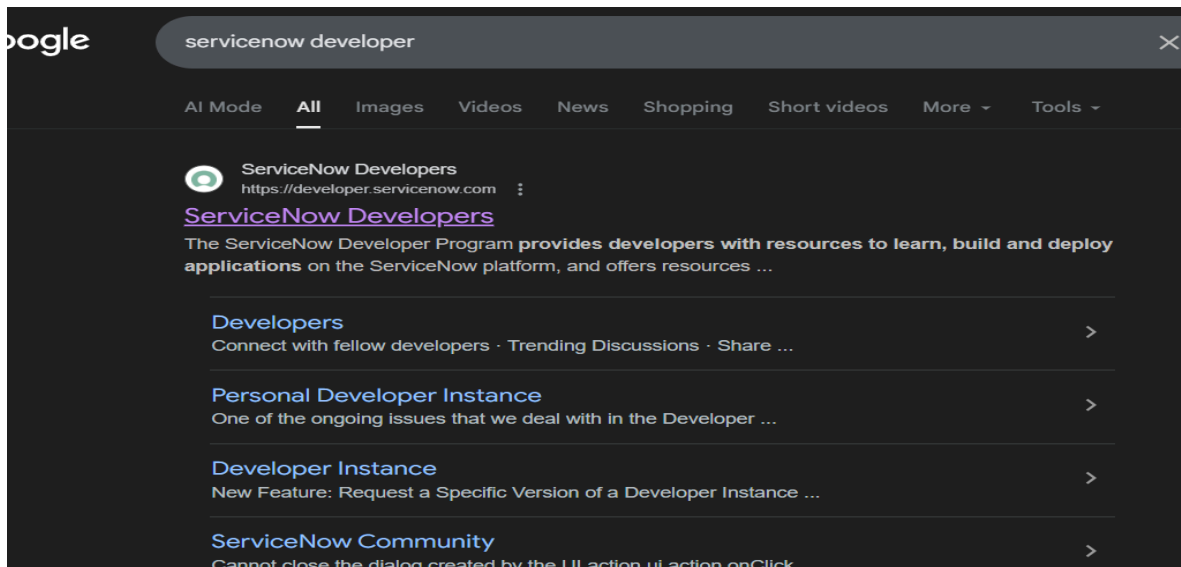
Important

- No development work should happen here.
- Even small mistakes can severely impact business.

2. Steps to Create a ServiceNow Instance

Step 1: Go to ServiceNow Developer Site

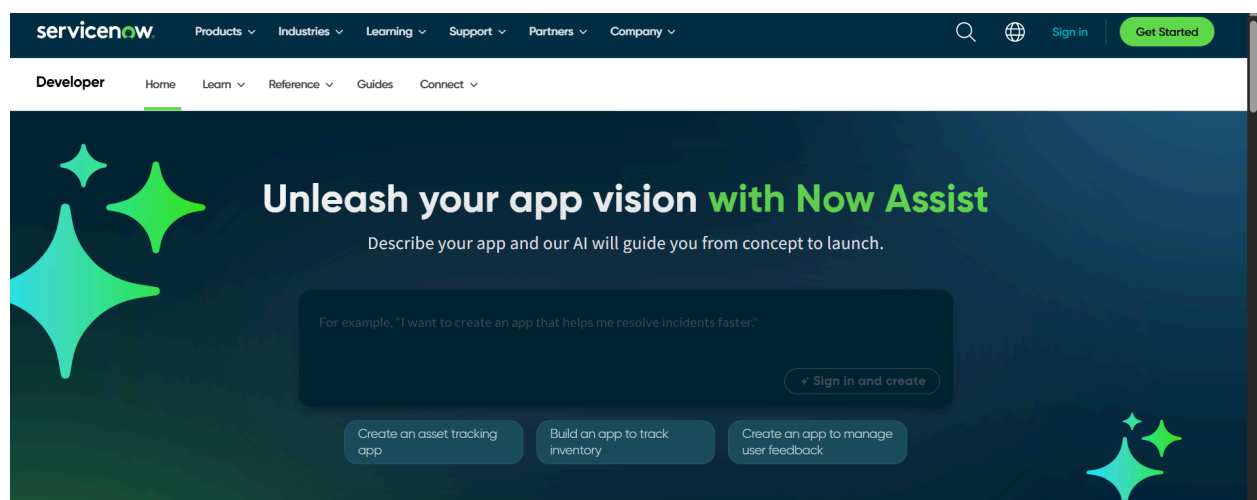
- Open your browser and visit: **developer.servicenow.com**
- This is the official platform from where developers get **free ServiceNow personal instances**.



Step 2: Sign Up / Log In

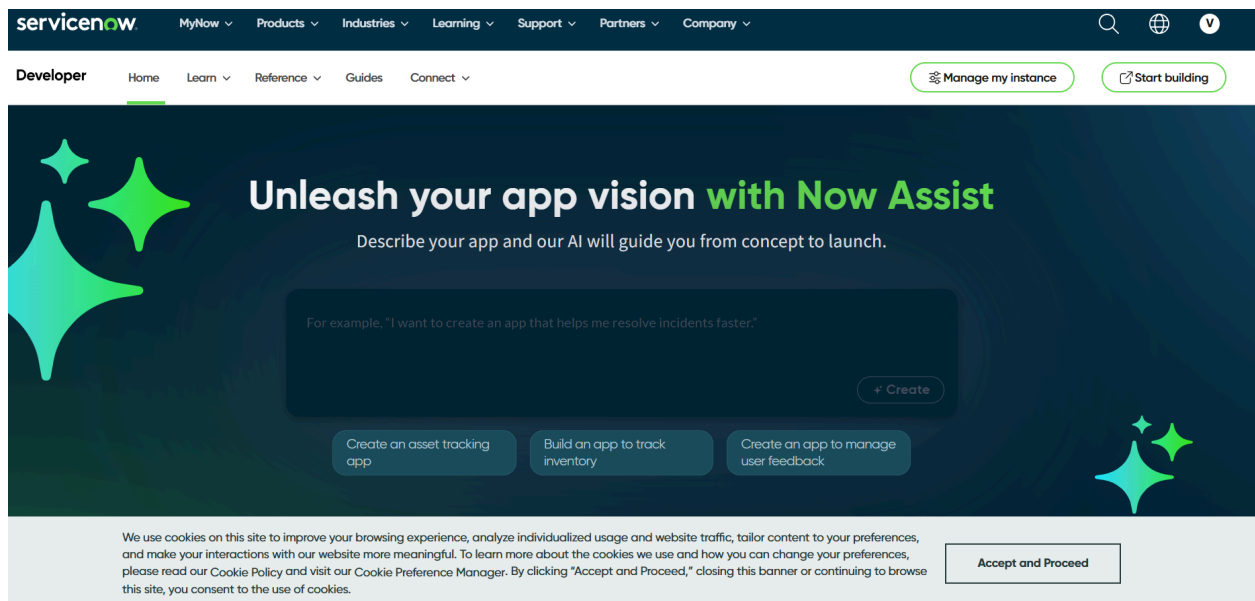
- If you already have an account → **Click “Sign In”**
- If you don't have an account → **Click “Register”**
 - Enter: Name, Email, Password, Country
 - Verify email to complete registration

You must log in to request an instance.



Step 3: Open the “Manage” / “Instance” Section

- After login, on the top menu select:
Manage → Instances
- This page shows:
 - Active instances
 - Option to request a new one
 - Status (Running, Hibernating, Offline etc.)



Step 4: Click “Request Instance”

- A pop-up will appear asking you to select **ServiceNow release version**
(for example: Kingston, Orlando, Rome, Utah, Vancouver depending on availability)

Choose the latest one (recommended)

Example: **Vancouver Release**

- Click **Request**

It may take ~2–5 minutes to create.

Step 5: Copy Your Instance URL & Login Credentials

Once creation is completed, the screen will show:

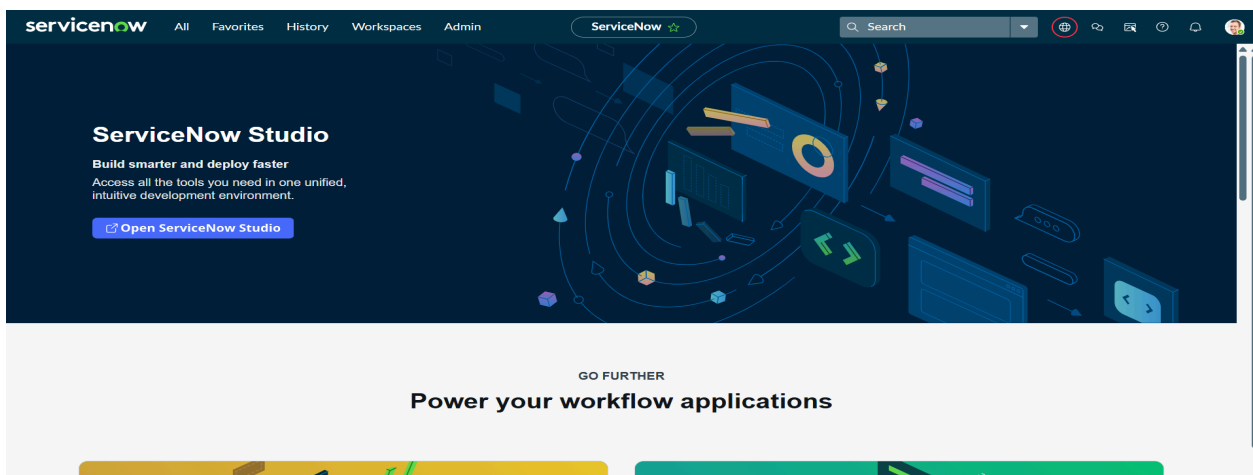
Field	Details
Instance URL	https://devXXXXX.service-now.com
Username	admin
Password	Auto-generated strong password

Save the password safely. It is visible only once.

Step 6: Login to the Instance

- Open the **Instance URL**
- Enter the **admin** username
- Paste the password → Login

You are now inside your **personal ServiceNow instance**.



3. User Interface (UI)

Definition

The **User Interface (UI)** is the visual and interactive layout of ServiceNow that allows users to view information, perform tasks, and navigate applications. It consists of modules, lists, forms, dashboards, and menus. The UI adapts based on user roles and permissions.

Purpose

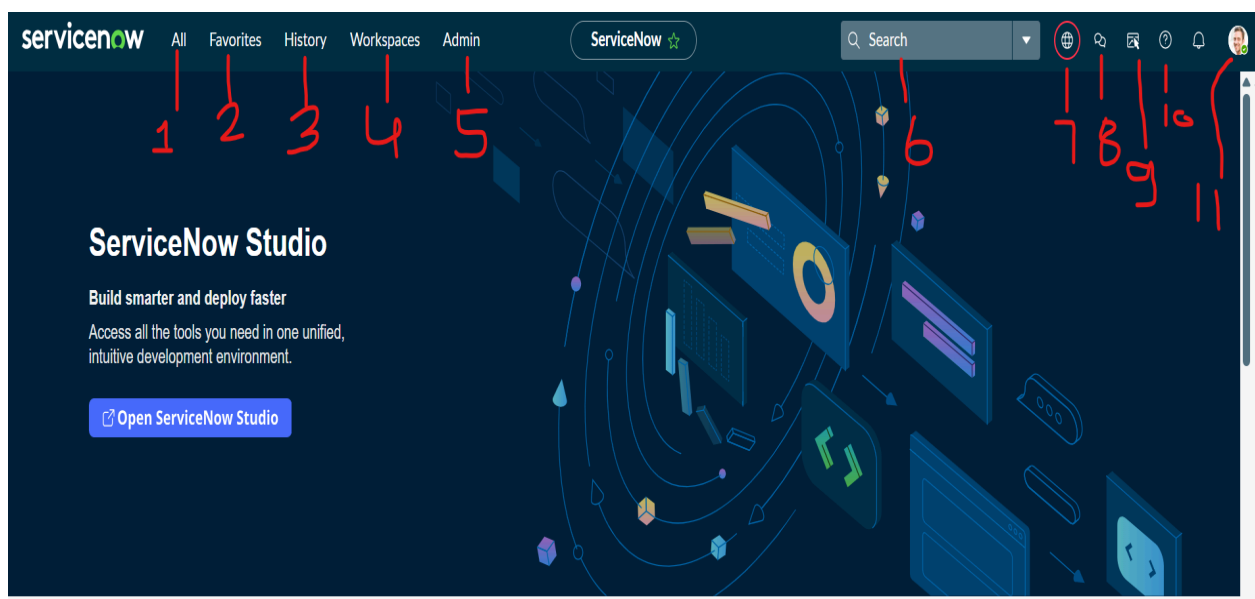
- To help users access modules and work efficiently.
- To simplify navigation and task execution.

Example Scenario

A Service Desk agent logs in → opens **Incident > All** → updates incident status → saves the record.

Complete UI Explanation

When you first log in to a ServiceNow developer instance using the admin account, you see the main user interface. The UI is designed in a way that allows developers and system administrators to search, navigate, configure and perform all activities from a single place.



1. All

This option shows the full list of all applications and modules available in your ServiceNow instance. If a user has permissions for something, it appears here. It is like a master menu to access everything — incidents, problems, catalog, scripts, tables, reports, etc.

2. Favourites

This section is for quick access. Any module or page that you open frequently can be saved as a favourite. Instead of searching every time, you can click from favourites and open directly. It saves time and improves productivity.

3. History

History keeps a record of recently opened pages/forms. If you opened a specific record, table, or module, it shows here. You can jump back to the previous items without searching again. It works like a browsing history inside ServiceNow.

4. Workspace

Workspace is a modern view of ServiceNow made for agents. It provides a cleaner UI with dashboards, lists, records, and tools together. It is mainly used in ITSM, CSM, HR and offers a fast, guided, task-focused experience.

(Example: ITSM Agent Workspace)

5. Admin

Admin means the privileged access used by ServiceNow administrators. It is not a menu but a role with capabilities like creating ACL, UI Policies, Business Rules, tables, fields, workflows, integrations, importing data, etc. Only users with admin role can manage system configuration and security.

6. Global Search

Global search lets you search anything across the instance from one place. You can search records, knowledge articles, catalog items, names, numbers, etc. It works like a universal search bar so you don't need to go inside a module to search.

7. Application Scope

Scope defines the boundary of an application. Anything built inside a scoped app is protected and isolated from other applications. Scripts, tables and APIs follow the scope rules. This avoids conflict between multiple apps in a single instance.

8. Sidebar Discussion

This feature allows users to chat or start conversations inside ServiceNow. You can discuss records with teammates directly on the right sidebar. It supports attachments and tagging the record so the chat context is not lost.

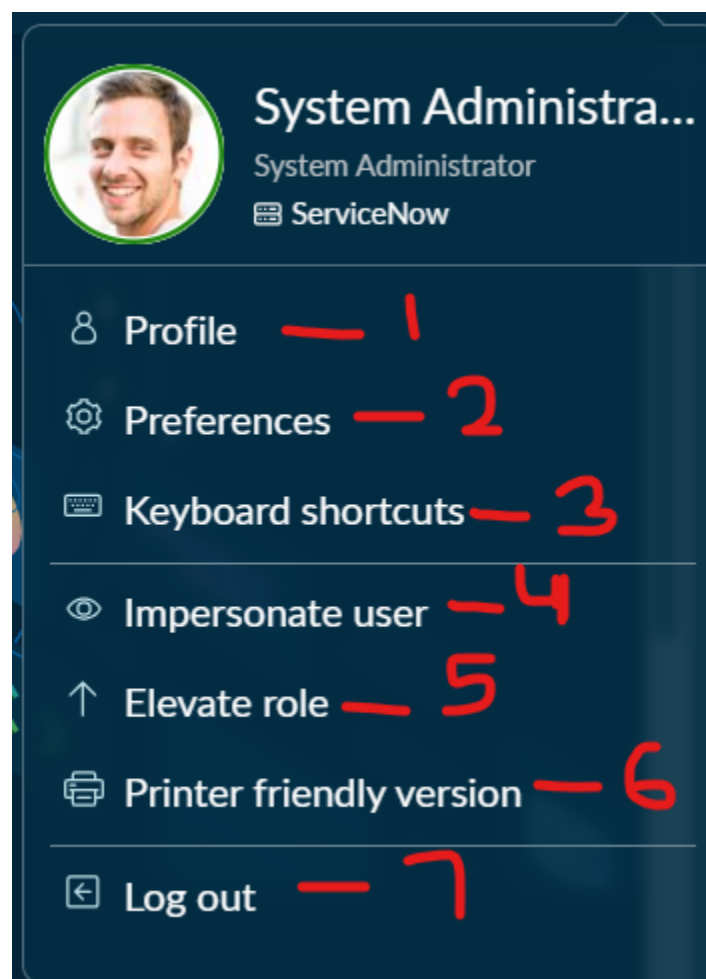
9. Usage Analytics

Usage analytics shows how much your instance is being used. It tracks login count, active users, pages visited, application usage, etc. This report helps admins understand user adoption and performance.

10. Show Help

Show help displays small guide text on the page to explain fields, actions, or modules. It is basically a built-in help tooltip that assists users in understanding what each part of the page means.

11. Inside system administrator



1. Profile

Opens the user's profile page where you can see and edit your personal details like name, email, phone, roles, groups, time zone, etc., depending on permissions.

2. Preferences

This is for personal UI settings. You can change theme, language, date/time format, list layouts, notification settings, and other display preferences. It affects only your own account.

3. Keyboard shortcuts

Shows a list of shortcut keys that can be used inside ServiceNow to perform actions quickly without using the mouse. Helpful for speeding up navigation and form actions.

4. Impersonate user

Lets the admin temporarily log in as another user without needing their password. Mostly used for testing permissions, UI issues, access issues, and troubleshooting.

5. Elevate role

Activates high-security roles (like security_admin) for a short time. Used for sensitive tasks such as modifying ACLs, access controls, encryption settings, and configuration security. After work, role should be lowered back.

6. Printer friendly version

Opens the current page in a clean, print-optimized format without extra UI elements, making it easy to print or save as a document.

7. Log out

Ends the current session and returns to the login page. Safest method to exit your account, especially on shared systems.